Cyber Security Threats

In recent years, most of the individuals and enterprises are facing problems due to the weaknesses inherent in security systems and compromised organizational infrastructures. Different types of Cyber Security Threats are categorized as below:

Phishing

Phishing is a type of computer crime used to attack, steal user data, including login name, password and credit card numbers e.t.c. through emails.

Pharming

Pharming is a scamming practice in which malicious code is installed on a personal computer or server, misdirecting users to fraudulent web sites without their knowledge or permission. Pharming has been called "**phishing without a trap**". It is another way hackers attempt to manipulate users on the Internet. It is a cyber-attack intended to redirect a website's traffic to a fake site.

Cookies

A cookie is a small piece of data sent from a website and stored on the user's computer memory (Hard drive) by the user's web browser while the user is browsing internet.

Web sites typically use cookies for the following reasons:

- To collect demographic information about who has visited the Web site.
- Sites often use this information to track how often visitors come to the site and how long they remain on the site.

Firewall and Proxy Servers

A firewall is a computer network security based system that monitors and controls incoming and outgoing network traffic based on predefined security rules. A firewall commonly establishes a block between a trusted internal computer network and entrusted computer outside the network.

A proxy server acts as an intermediary between the end users and a web server. The proxy server examines the request, checks authenticity and grants the request.

Encryption and Decryption

Encryption and decryption are processes that ensure confidentiality that only authorized persons can access the information.

Encryption is the process of translating the plain text data (plaintext) into random and mangled data (called cipher-text).

Decryption is the reverse process of converting the cipher-text back to plaintext.Encryption and decryption are done by cryptography. In cryptography a key is a piece of information (parameter) that determines the functional output of a cryptographic algorithm.

Encryption is used to protect data in communication system, for example data being transferred via networks (e.g. the Internet, ecommerce), mobile telephones, wireless microphones, wireless intercom systems, Bluetooth devices and bank automatic teller machines.

17.4 INTRODUCTION TO INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY ACT

In the 21st century, Computer, Internet and ICT or e-revolution has changed the life style of the people. Apart from positive side of e-revolution there is also negative side of computer, that

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